

NAB Legal Mandate and Establishment

The National Accountability Bureau (NAB) was established under the National Accountability Ordinance, 1999. The Ordinance created NAB as an independent, autonomous body with the mandate to eradicate corruption and corrupt practices, hold accountable those in positions of power and authority, and recover looted public money for the national exchequer.

NAB's jurisdiction covers corruption and corruption-related offences committed by public office holders, government servants, and persons acting in connivance with them. Following the accountability law amendments, NAB's primary focus is on cases involving public-sector corruption of significant financial value, with smaller matters typically referred to other relevant law-enforcement or provincial anti-corruption agencies.

NAB is headed by a Chairman NAB, who is appointed by the President of Pakistan in consultation with the Prime Minister and the Leader of the Opposition in the National Assembly, for a non-extendable term. The Chairman is supported by a Deputy Chairman and a Prosecutor General Accountability, who heads the prosecution wing.

NAB's day-to-day work is organized into four core functional departments: the Operations Department (investigation of corruption references), the Prevention Department (systemic reforms to reduce opportunities for corruption), the Awareness Department (public education and outreach), and the Prosecution Department (litigation of references before Accountability Courts).